

RUNNING AI, HONESTLY

**MY AI BILL
WAS
NEVER THE
PROBLEM.**

SWIPE →

THE RISE I WAS WATCHING

Anthropic had a price increase scheduled for the first of September. One of its main models was going up by half.

THEN IT WAS CALLED OFF

On 10 August the lower introductory price became the standard one. The rise is not happening at all.

THE NUMBER I MISSED

It was inside my own code. My agents had started falling over, and the price of anything had nothing to do with it.

WHAT THEY WERE DOING

Pulling in more text than they needed. Keeping everything they had ever produced. Redoing work they had already finished.

THREE FIXES, NONE OF THEM NEW

Cap what goes in. Throw away old records. Check whether the job has already been done. I wrote all three into bank payment systems years ago.

WHAT CHANGED

Each run started using about a seventh of what it used to. Same work, same output, a fraction of the load.

THE TWO NUMBERS TOGETHER

The price was going to move by half. My runs were using seven times what they needed. Only one of those was ever mine to fix.

**THE BIGGER
NUMBER WAS
ALWAYS MINE.**

Let's count what we waste.